

The 7-Day Idea Validation Mini-Course

A free playbook from SoloSuccess Academy. Evenings and weekends. Under \$100. One real signal at the end.

Why most validation advice fails

Most advice tells you to write a 40-page business plan, run a SWOT, and forecast five-year revenue. That is not validation. That is procrastination dressed up as rigor.

Real validation is one thing: **evidence that strangers will give you money for what you are proposing** — before you have built it. Everything else is opinion.

What counts as a real signal

Strong signals (what we are hunting for):

- A pre-order or paid deposit.
- A signed letter of intent (B2B).
- A waitlist with unsolicited 'when can I buy?' replies.
- Someone offering to pay you to do it manually, today.

Weak signals (do not count):

- Survey answers of 'yes, I would buy this.'
- Friends and family saying 'great idea!'
- LinkedIn likes on your post about the idea.
- Email signups with no follow-up engagement.

The 7-day sprint

Day 1 — Write the one-sentence offer

Before you talk to anyone, force yourself to write your idea in a single sentence:

I help [specific person] achieve [specific outcome] by [specific mechanism] for [specific price].

If you cannot fill in all four blanks, you are not ready to validate — you are ready to think more.

Day 2 — List 20 real people who fit the description

Not 'small business owners.' Twenty specific humans by name, in LinkedIn or a spreadsheet, who would be the buyer.

If you cannot list 20, the niche is too vague. Go narrower.

Days 3-4 — Five problem-discovery conversations

Reach out with one ask: 'I am researching how [your role] handles [problem]. Could I get 15 minutes? Not selling anything.' Aim for five accepts.

Ask only about current behavior — never pitch.

Walk me through the last time you faced [problem]. What did you do? What was frustrating? What did it cost you?

Day 5 — Build a one-page fake-door landing page

Use Carrd, Framer, or a single page. Headline = your Day 1 sentence as a benefit. Three bullets. Price visible. One CTA: 'Pre-order — pay \$X now' via Stripe Payment Links.

If a card gets charged, that is a strong signal. If they bounce on the Stripe page, the offer is interesting and the price is not — useful too.

Day 6 — Drive 200-500 visitors

Pick ONE source — do not try all:

\$20-\$50 of Meta or Reddit ads. One post in a relevant subreddit or Slack. Direct DMs to the other 15 people on your Day 2 list.

Day 7 — Read the signal and decide

Three possible outcomes:

GREEN: 1+ paid pre-orders. Refund anyone who asks, then build the smallest version that delivers.

YELLOW: Strong click-throughs, no payments. Rewrite price or framing. Re-run Day 5-7 with ONE variable changed.

RED: Low engagement, no payments. Audience or problem is wrong. Go back to Day 1. This is the entire point of validation.

The four mistakes that ruin sprints

1. Asking friends and family.

They lie to be kind. Talk to strangers in your target market.

2. Pitching instead of asking.

You will get false positives from people being polite about your idea instead of honest about their problem.

3. Hiding the price.

'Contact us for pricing' makes the test meaningless. The price is half of what you are validating.

4. Building before validating.

If you have written more than zero lines of product code by Day 7, you moved the goalposts from 'do they want it?' to 'did I waste my weekend?'

Want the full playbook — with templates, scripts, and an AI tutor that reviews your offer line by line?

Course 1 of SoloSuccess Academy walks you through this 7-day sprint end to end.

solosuccessacademy.app/courses

SoloSuccess Academy · solosuccessacademy.app

Free to share. Not for resale.